

**Activity Report  
Of  
One Day Technical Workshop on  
“Current Status of Technical Assistance in Reconstruction and its Challenges”**



**Under Housing Recovery and Reconstruction Platform-Nepal (HRRP)**

Organizers :

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**HRRP**

Date: Feb 7, 2017

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## **1. INTRODUCTION**

### **1.1 Background**

The role of partner organizations (PO) in the earthquake affected districts is of paramount importance. According to the inspection Standard Operating Procedure, POs are expected to provide Technical Assistance (TA) to the people. Delivering TA to the people, however, is full of challenges to the POs involved.

In a bid to support POs to identify challenges and craft possible solutions to overcome those difficulties, HRRP in cooperation with NRA and DUDBC of Sindhupalchok, organized this one day technical workshop.

Sindhupalchok is a hilly district of Nepal in northern part of the country which is almost three hour's drive from the country's capital, Kathmandu. There are 2 municipalities and 68 VDCs in with total population of 287,798. Likewise, out of 78,537 eligible beneficiaries, 74,870 have enrolled, 73,552 have received the first tranche. Subsequently, 4,647 have started layout, 925 have applied for second tranche. Yet, 14,447 are still out of the relief package, therefore have filed for grievance.

The majority of the reconstruction in Sindhupalchowk is of stone masonry with mud mortar, whereas in urban areas, RCC structures are being constructed.

Almost 20 Partner Organizations have been working in Sindhupalchowk. As there have been 2-3 months gap in HRRP Sindhupalchowk, our team have been working to compensate the gap and update all the records and 4W.

### **1.2 Workshop Goal**

The workshop aims to identify the challenges being faced by the POs while providing TA to the people, and supports to design possible solutions to overcome them.

### **1.3 Workshop Objectives**

- To share the experience of POs on the housing reconstruction
- To collect the challenges on the Technical Assistance for safer reconstruction.
- To collect the ideas on possible improvement from field to provide the adequate Technical Assistance.
- To identify the gaps on the Technical Assistance in the District
- To identify the duplications and overlap on the Technical Assistance
- To evaluate the impact of IEC material developed and Disseminate by NRA and CLPIU

## 1.4 Workshop Participants

The invitees of the workshop were from DUDBC/DLPIU, NRA, HRRP, UN Agency, INGOs and NGOs. Altogether, there were 36 participants. Chief of DUDBC/DLPIU and NRA focal point were present from the government side whereas program managers, senior project officers, officers, MEAL officers, engineers, assistant engineers and assistant sub engineers were at the venue from POs.

Mr. Rup Kumar BK, District Coordinator, HRRP Sindhupalchowk coordinated the overall execution of the workshop. In addition, his colleagues—Ms Aarju Basnet, Technical Coordinator and Ms Manisha Rai, Information Management Officer—supported in logistics and necessary arrangements.

Further, Mr. Kuber K. Bogati, National Technical Officer, HRRP, facilitated the workshop.

Mr. Bhubaneswor Lamichhane, NRA District Chief welcomed the participants of the workshop program. Mr. Youb Raj Poudyal, Division Head, DUDBC Office, also welcomed the participants and highlighted the gaps and duplications in the reconstruction process in the district. Mr. Kuber K. Bogati briefed about the workshop objectives and the expected output from the workshop.

The list of participants is included in Annex 1.

## 1.5 Workshop Schedule

| One Day Technical Workshop on<br>"Current Status of Technical Assistance in Reconstruction and it's Challenges" |       |         |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------|---------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Time                                                                                                            |       | Session | Description                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
| 9:00                                                                                                            | 9:30  | S0      | Arrival/Registration/Breakfast                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
| 9:30                                                                                                            | 9:45  | S1      | Opening Session : Introduction, Overview and Objective of Workshop, Group Photographs                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
| 9:45                                                                                                            | 11:30 | S2      | Experience Sharing on Technical Assistance in the District from POs                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
| 11:30                                                                                                           | 12:15 |         | Lunch                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
| 12:15                                                                                                           | 14:15 | S3      | Evaluation of Reconstructed Houses w.r.t. Standard Operating Procedures (SOP), Nepal National Building Codes (NBC ** 2015) and Updated Technical Guidelines<br>- Challenges in Technical Assistance in the Reconstruction Works<br>- Possible ideas to improve the technical assistance to make reconstruction more smooth and compliance standards<br>(Group Work) |
| 14:15                                                                                                           | 15:15 | S4      | Group work Presentation                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
| 15:15                                                                                                           | 15:30 |         | Tea                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
| 15:30                                                                                                           | 16:00 | S5      | Overview on Published Documents by GON and its Current Implementation Status                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
| 16:00                                                                                                           | 16:15 | S0      | Closing Session : Closing Remarks<br>(NRA, DLPIU, POs )                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |

## 1.6 Methodology

The workshop proceeded with sharing of experiences, identifying challenges, then creating possible solutions to those problems.

Firstly, there was a formal session where DUDBC Chief, Dr. Youb Raj Poudyal chaired the program. Likewise, Executive Officer of Chautara Municipality and NRA focal person, Mr. Bhuwaneswor Lamichhane, co-chaired the session. Mr Lamichhane welcomed the participants, then presented some of the challenges. Next, Dr. Poudyal manifested some of the issues and the expectation from the participants.

Secondly, the workshop session began where Mr Kuber Bogati started the sessions.

Subsequently, POs started making presentation on their experiences on providing technical assistance and the challenges being faced.

Next, participants were divided into 4 groups with each groups assigned with a topic, namely group 1--further Challenges w.r.t. SOP/NBC/Guidelines; group 2--Implementation Status of Published Guidelines; group 3--Suggestion from Field on Technical Guidelines; and group 4--Evaluation of Reconstructed Houses w.r.t SOP/NBC/Guidelines.

The presentation by the POs showcased issues which have posed difficulties to smoothly delivering technical assistance in the district.

- Some of the house designs are not feasible for large family members.
- Mobile network is unreachable in many VDCs which creates problems in data tracking and recording.
- Some VDCs do not have access to roads due to which transporting of materials have become expensive.
- Some beneficiaries have died, and some are handicapped, or old, due to which they cannot get the grant from the bank.
- Receiving of second tranche is very tiresome process for the beneficiaries. Considerable number of beneficiaries were not in the process due to minor deviations. Zero flexibility in checklist has caused serious problems.
- Sindhupalchowk is not water logged but still, the criteria to have DPC level 1 ft above the ground is checked and it is not even handicapped and old age friendly.
- Some lands had depressions after the earthquake
- One catalogue which is stone masonry with mud mortar has attic and people have already constructed houses according to that design
- Lack of human resources and construction materials
- High demand of the workforce has increased wage.

## 1.7 Workshop Output

### 1.7.1 Major Challenges in the reconstruction

- Lack of orientation to community for reconstruction
- Scarcity of Water
- Difficult terrains has affected material transportation thereby making them expensive.
- Unavailability of DLPIU engineers in the community to process for 2nd tranche.
- Lack of proper ideas on retrofitting of structures
- Insufficient, and sometimes conflicting Technical Assistance (between DLIPU and PO's engineers) in community
- 17 Government designs are insufficient
- Designs on blocks, timber, truss, earth bags are still unconfirmed
- Communities are unaware of SOP 2073
- Lack of coordination between government, POs and beneficiaries
- Variation in technical specification in SOP 2073, Building Code and Design Catalogue
- TOT training lacking/insufficient to municipality engineers and sub engineers
- Insufficient assistance to community (lack of help desk, information boards, demo construction)
- Construction of composite structures
- Exclusion of other types of buildings
- Only soft wood available in the district which is less appropriate for building construction.
- Masons are increasing their wage rate after attending TOT
- Masons are travelling to adjacent or farther VDCs after training.
- Municipality engineers do not follow NBC and SOP
- DLPIU engineers are barely available in the villages.
- Some people have two storied houses approved, but they only make one storey for now which might cause problems to receive final certification letter from VDC
- Land in the name of Guthis in municipalities is an issue
- Specification for mud mortar isn't provided. For instance, the quantity of straw or other materials to be added in the mud, and also not all mud could be feasible for mortar.

- Vaastu and guidelines deviate for criterias on openings, as Vaastu recommends a door and a window in East, which is a problem for <0.3L criteria of openings
- As per the guideline, passage will be of 7 ft(3 ft door, and 2 ft gap on either side)
- Practice of welding rebars
- Roof and wall connections aren't taught properly to masons
- Urban mason training is not enough
- Illiterate people have difficulties in filling up the form
- Some people are constructing corner stones throughout the length

### **1.7.2 Possible ideas to sort out the current challenges**

- TOT and SOP trainings to be given to municipality engineers and sub engineers
- Seasoning of wood by drying should be promoted in the villages.
- Certificate to be provided to masons only after skill testing
- Flexibility in inspection SOP needed.
- POs to coordinate with organizations working in WASH sector
- Monthly targets by each POs to be well defined
- All POs have separated around 7% monitoring fund for Ministry of Finance, but they do not monitor. If monitoring could be conducted, better performances can be achieved
- Woods to be distributed by District Forest Office at a reasonable rate
- Adequate skill enhancement activities
- Effective tracking of masons, and follow ups needed.
- Improvement of infrastructures like roads, electricities, water facilities to be facilitated by the government.
- Mobile vehicles to disseminate news and information and also awareness programs once in a month
- Journalists should frequently publish updated news at local level
- Establishment of Help Desk in VDCs
- More Door to Door Assistance required.
- Support in Livelihood programs also needed.
- Refresher and regular training to engineers and masons
- SOP inspection orientation to VDC Secretaries

- Community awareness programs
- Retrofitting trainings to be provided to senior engineers
- Labor wages should be properly monitored and regulated in VDC level
- Proper coordination among governemental and non governmental organisations
- Ease procedures in government offices.
- Effective attendance monitoring system of DLPIU engineers
- Cash for works programs



## Annexes

## Annex 1: Participants Attendance

## HRRP

## HOUSING RECONSTRUCTION &amp; RECOVERY PLATFORM NEPAL - SINDHUPALCHOK

| S.N. | AGENCY         | FIRST NAME      | LAST NAME   | DESIGNATION              | PHONE NUMBER | EMAIL                           | SIGNATURE    |
|------|----------------|-----------------|-------------|--------------------------|--------------|---------------------------------|--------------|
| 1    | Janahit (JESS) | Prasan          | Thapa       | Shelter officer          | 9813880487   | thapaprasant487@gmail.com       | Prasan       |
| 2    | LWF            | Madan Kumar     | Pandey      | District Project Manager | 9804392225   | madan.p@lwf.org.np              | Madan Pandey |
| 3    | GMSP           | Shishir Kumar   | Nurung      | District Project officer | 9891132336   | gmsspshishirgurung@gmail.com    | Shishir      |
| 4    | Build Change   | Kriti           | Rajkarnikar | Staff Architect          | 9861444410   | kriti@buildchange.org           | Kriti        |
| 5    | ARSON Nepal    | Nikita          | Mandhar     | Engineer                 | 9841708669   | nikita-mandhar@gmail.com        | Nikita       |
| 6    | World Vision   | Anmol           | Shrestha    | Shelter Engg.            | 9841637476   | anmol-shrestha@wvi.org          | Anmol        |
| 7    | ARSON Nepal    | Sulab           | Khatiwada   | Technical Officer        | 9851181358   | khatiwada-sulab@hotmail.com     | Sulab        |
| 8    | ARSON NEPAL    | Rohit           | Gautam      | Technical Officer        | 9807411171   | rohitr7003@gmail.com            | Rohit        |
| 9    | IKI            | Pravesh         | Gautam      | Shelter officer          | 9899121830   | enterdareveluh@gmail.com        | Pravesh      |
| 10   | NRCS           | Gopal Bdr.      | Bhat        | J. E                     | 9808703025   | gbbhat2048@gmail.com            | Gopal        |
| 11   | NRCS           | Nilesh          | Rawal       | Junior Engineer          | 9843521932   | rawalnilesh@gmail.com           | Nilesh       |
| 12   | NRCS           | Dinesh          | Subedi      | Shelter officer          | 9845044489   | dinesh.sos2@gmail.com           | Dinesh       |
| 13   | ARSON-Nepal    | Pradeep         | Kunwar      | Technical Officer        | 9814633318   | kunwar.p99@gmail.com            | Pradeep      |
| 14   | TGH            | Ammandine       | ARDWIN      | Progn. Coordinator       | 980201737    | ccoordprog.nepal@trianglegh.org | Ammandine    |
| 15   | TGH            | Karolina        | BRACH       | Architect Engineer       | 981046746    | archi.nepal@trianglegh.org      | Karolina     |
| 16   | CARITAS NEPAL  | Jhaggu          | Chaudhary   | District Prog. Coord.    | 9844115941   | jhaggussc@gmail.com             | Jhaggu       |
| 17   | "              | Pradip          | Dhakal      | Shelter Coordinator      | 9801317290   | dhakalpradip3@gmail.com         | Pradip       |
| 18   | JICA           | Lok Bdr. Rokaya | Rokaya      | Cluster leader           | 985115267    | er.rokayalok@gmail.com          | Lok          |
| 19   | JICA           | Bidur           | Gautam      | Cluster leader, Mahabari | 984728815    | bidurgautam1@gmail.com          | Bidur        |
| 20   | CFP/UNHCR      | Arbin           | Rai         | District Liaison Officer | 9841794350   | arbin.raibone.un.org            | Arbin        |
| 21   | MEDY CORPS     | Satya Xargan    | Choudhary   | Sr. Project officer      | 9851141228   | s.choudhary@medycorps.org       | Satya        |
| 22   | SABAL          | Pradip          | Sharma      | Sr. Engineer             | 9851073208   | sharmapr48@gmail.com            | Pradip       |
| 23   | HELVETAS       | Niraj           | Maharyan    | Shelter Officer          | 984170496    | niraj.maharyan@helvetas.org     | Niraj        |
| 24   | HELVETAS       | Deb Raj         | Mishra      | Shelter officer          | 98460451     | deb.mishra@helvetas.org         | Deb Raj      |
| 25   | UNDP           | Suman           | Dahal       | District Engineer        | 9849122322   | suman.dahal@undp.org            | Suman        |
| 26   | Oxfam          | Ashish P.       | Dhakal      | Shelter officer          | 9851128965   | adhakal@oxfam.org.uk            | Ashish       |

HRRP - One Day Technical Workshop - Sindhupalchok

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## HRRP

## HOUSING RECONSTRUCTION &amp; RECOVERY PLATFORM NEPAL - SINDHUPALCHOK

| S.N. | AGENCY      | FIRST NAME    | LAST NAME  | DESIGNATION               | PHONE NUMBER | EMAIL                     | SIGNATURE |
|------|-------------|---------------|------------|---------------------------|--------------|---------------------------|-----------|
| 27   | DLPIU, MoUD | DR YOUNG RAJ  | PAUDYAL    | CHIEF (PD)                | 9851191158   | yrpandya@gmail.com        |           |
| 28   | ISAP        | Sushil        | Adhikari   | District Technical Coord. | 9849981439   | sushil@isap.org.np        |           |
| 29   | ISAP        | Gopi Krishna  | Dongal     | Field Coordinator         | 9866361697   | Gopi@isap.org.np          |           |
| 30   | HRRP        | Raj Barret    | Barret     | District Tech. Co.        | 9851218254   | rjubarret@gmail.com       |           |
| 31   | MdM+France  | Ganesh        | Shrestha   | Project Manager           | 9851082231   | ganesh@smail.com          |           |
| 32   | HRRP        | Kuber Bogati  |            | Math Tech. Coordinator    | 9851199903   | kubogati@nset.org.np      |           |
| 33   | NRA         | Bhubane Swast | Lamichhane | E.O.                      | 9841327631   | b1143496@gmail.com        |           |
| 34   | HRRP        | Manisha       | Kai        | IM focal person           | 9842062006   | im.sindhupalchok@hrrp.org |           |
| 35   | TUCI        | Binod Raj     | Giri       | Shelter officer           | 9849666783   | binodraaj@outlook.com     |           |
| 36   | HRRP        | Rup Kumar     | BK         | DC                        | 9851140628   | rupkumar@hrrpnepal.org    |           |
| 37   |             |               |            |                           |              |                           |           |
| 38   |             |               |            |                           |              |                           |           |
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| 51   |             |               |            |                           |              |                           |           |



## Annex 2: Photographs



Mr Bhuwaneswor Lamichhane, NRA Focal Person, presenting Issues and Challenges in reconstruction in the district.



Participants of the workshop



Participants presenting their group work and responding to the queries.



Presentation on Issues and Challenges on Technical Assistance by one of the participants.



Dr. Youb Raj Poudyal, Chief of DUDBC, Sindhupalchok, responding to the queries of the POs.



Group photo after the technical workshop.